

identify it on a network and choose if you wish to login to the account automatically.

The last step before the installation begins shows a brief of all the settings you've selected. If you need to make any changes, you should make them now. Click on Install to begin the installation. The installation may take around 10 minutes or more depending on your system configuration. At the end, the installation will need you to remove the disk from the drive and reboot. If you have Windows installed for example, you'll get a option to choose which operating system to boot into.

There is another way of installing Linux alongside Windows without partitioning the hard drive. The distribution is installed on a single file on the hard drive. Wubi is the name of this application. All you need to do is download Wubi and place in the same folder as the image file. The installation steps are pretty identical to the one using the disc.

5.1.2 Interface and Customising

Ubuntu's desktop is really simple to understand. It's similar to the Windows desktop in many ways with just the placement and locations of some of the menus changed. The panel at the bottom as it is acts like your taskbar and all running applications show up there. To the right end of the panel is the list of virtual desktops. The one on the left is active by default and the one on the right can be used if you run out of desktop space for applications. The trash bin is also present there.

Ubuntu runs on Gnome, so a lot of the distributions running on it will have the similar elements on the interface. Customizing them is almost identical. There is no single Start button on the interface instead there are several menus visible on the top. The Applications menu is the most important one and houses all the applications installed on your PC. The Places menu is used to access the different drives and network computers. The System menu has links to all the system preferences, settings and customization menus. The rest of the bar contains shortcut icons to applications like the Quicklaunch bar in Windows.

The menus and listing of applications can be modified as well. Right-click on any of the menus on the top and click on Edit menus. This window shows the menus and the submenus